

Rules Authoring Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **constraints, validations, classifications, derivations, equivalences, and state transitions**.

This guide is about **what must be true, what is allowed, and how values or states are determined**.

What belongs here

- invariants that must always hold
- validation requirements at boundaries
- rules that classify something
- rules that derive a value
- transition rules between states

What does not belong here

- a whole story flow
- raw concept definitions without a rule
- generic design preferences disguised as mandatory business rules

Core things to capture

- the rule statement
- when it applies
- what it requires or forbids
- which concepts or states it affects
- what happens if it is violated

Core relationships to capture

- rule -> concept affected
- rule -> state transition controlled
- rule -> operation or screen where it matters

- rule -> business consequence if broken

Modus operandi

Write rules as explicit business statements:

1. name the rule
2. describe when it applies
3. describe what must or must not happen
4. identify concepts, states, and outcomes affected
5. separate rule meaning from implementation technique

Prompt set

- what must always be true?
- what is forbidden?
- what decides the category or status?
- how is a value derived?
- what conditions allow a state change?

Free-text intake template

- **Rule name:**
- **Type (constraint/validation/classification/derivation/transition):**
- **When it applies:**
- **What it requires or forbids:**
- **Affected concepts/states:**
- **Business consequence if broken:**

Worked example

- A leave request may not be approved if remaining leave balance is insufficient
- A medical leave request must be classified separately when documentation is required
- A submitted leave request may transition to approved, rejected, or cancelled

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into structural, validation, classification, derivation, equivalence, or transition rule entries linked to concepts and operations.

Common mistakes

- describing a habit or preference as if it were a rule
- forgetting when the rule applies
- mixing process narrative with rule definition
- omitting the affected concept or state